

land in communities where he ministered. The net result was a lot of wealth.

"What was your system?" I asked.

"Simple," he said. "I never bought a new car. I took whatever money I would have used to buy a new car and invested it."

I asked what advice he would give a young couple just starting out. "That's simple enough," he said. "Always spend less than you make and remember that it's better to earn interest than to pay it."

Once during one of our radio talk shows, I mentioned that anyone making more than \$15,000 a year could become a millionaire if he desired to. Later, a listener wrote to say that he didn't believe it was possible for an average-income person to get wealthy like I said, at least not without taking a lot of risks. So I sent him the following information:

If, at age 25 you could invest \$167 per month and earn 10 percent on your money, at age 65 you would have accumulated \$1,056,121.

The principle is very simple. A little bit over a long time becomes a lot.

DANGER SIGN: NO TITHE

Another danger sign that many couples experience is when they say, "*We can't tithe*; we just don't make enough money." You will never make enough money to tithe. It doesn't get easier, the more money you make. In fact, it's easier to tithe \$1,000 when you make \$10,000 than it is to tithe \$10,000 when you make \$100,000. Why? Because you adjust to spending more.

Let me make it clear. You don't get closer to God by making a commitment to tithe. A commitment to tithe is a sign of a couple that *has* gotten close to God. Tithing is not a command or a law; it is an outward indicator that you acknowledge God's ownership of everything.

If you don't tithe, that doesn't mean that God is going to strike you dead. Some people give because they believe if they